iClearer developer handoff

Start here · November 2026

This is the starting point for building iClearer. It explains what each file is, how to use the prototypes, what the app must do, and what is still open. The app is built natively in Swift.

1. What you are getting

Item	What it is	Where
App prototype	Clickable design of the whole Mac app, with every screen, menu and state	Open prototype or `prototypes/iclearer-app-prototype.html`
Landing page prototype	The marketing site, interactive	Open page or `prototypes/iclearer-landing.html`
Feature specification	What to build for 1.0 and 1.1, plan limits, free-plan masking rules, done checks	Open spec
License and device locking	Activation, hashed hardware ID, offline grace, abuse handling	Open doc
Pricing page copy	Plans and prices as buyers see them	Open doc
Design tokens	Colors, radii, spacing, type, icon colors, prices	`design-tokens.json`
Brand assets	Logos (SVG and PNG), favicon, icon layers, brand presentation	`brand/`

Important: the prototypes are HTML mock-ups that show the intended look and behavior. They are not production code. Build the app in Swift. If the links do not open for you, ask the account owner to share them, or use the files in the zip.

2. How to use the app prototype

Open it on a desktop browser. The strip at the top controls the demo:

- **Plan:** Free, Yearly, One-time. Compare each screen across the three.
- **Macs:** 1, 2 or 5. Changes the device list in Account.
- **Light or Dark.**
- **Simulate:** Normal, Untested macOS, No disk access, Offline license.
- **Replay first run.**

Every menu in the menu bar works. Shortcuts work too: Ctrl or Command with 1 to 9 to move between sections, R to rescan, Z to undo, comma for Settings. Click the small iClearer icon at the right of the menu bar to see the 1.1 menu bar monitor.

All names, sizes, paths and numbers are made up. The real values come from the scan.

3. Rules the code must enforce

Full detail is in the feature specification. The short version:

- Nothing is deleted without the user's action. Everything goes to the Trash. Undo works right after a cleanup.
- Keychain, accounts, editor user data, tokens, SSH keys, .env files and git folders can never be selected, in the interface or in code.
- Ask first items start unticked. Safe items start ticked.
- On a macOS version we have not tested, scanning works and cleaning is off.
- **Free users must never be able to find an item on disk from what the app shows.** They see category names, sizes and Safe or Ask first labels only. Names, details, locations, Reveal in Finder, file names, Quick Look and leftover sizes are paid. Free cleanup is 500 MB in total per Mac. See the masking rules in the spec.
- The number of Macs (1, 2 or 5) only changes how many Macs a license activates on. Features are the same.

4. Screens

Screen	Purpose	Free	Paid
First run	Welcome, email, Full Disk Access, scan	Same	Same
Overview	Total found, Safe amount, category tiles, disk bar	Full	Full
Clean	List grouped Everyday and Builders, inspector, floating total bar	Masked names, generic notes, 500 MB cap	Real names, details, locations, no cap
Storage Map	Ring chart of the disk	Top level only	Drill-down
Large and Old Files	Big files not opened in months	Kind and size, top 5, no names	Names, locations, Quick Look, Trash
Apps	App list with leftovers	Names and sizes, no leftovers, no uninstall	Leftovers, Uninstall
Builders	Developer and AI tool leftovers by tool	Generic labels, scan only	Tool names, cleanup
Startup Items	What opens at login	Blurred preview	List and switches
Privacy Check	Which apps use camera, mic, files	Blurred preview	Full list
History	Past cleanups with restore	Locked	Full
Duplicates (1.1)	Identical files	Blurred preview	Full
Maintenance (1.1)	Small fixes	Blurred preview	Run tasks
Settings	General, Notifications, Scanning, Protected, Schedule, Account	Partly locked	Full
Account	Email, license, devices, restore, sign out	Yes	Yes

Screen	Purpose	Free	Paid
Menu bar monitor (1.1)	Free space popover	Locked	Monthly and yearly only

States to build, all shown in the prototype: scanning, Nothing to clean, no search matches, empty History, over the free allowance (upgrade sheet), Ask first confirmation, one item in use (retry), untested macOS, no Full Disk Access, offline license warning.

Also built: Upgrade sheet, About, Check for Updates, Export Report, iClearer Help, Cleanup Rules, Keyboard Shortcuts, Quick Look sheet, uninstall confirmation, Sign in or activate, Change email.

5. Design system

All values are in `design-tokens.json`. In short:

- **Layout:** a translucent sidebar on the left (240 pt), an inset rounded content panel, an optional inspector on the right (292 pt), a floating action bar at the bottom, sheets for dialogs.
- **Look:** current Mac Liquid Glass style. Use the system materials and standard controls where you can, and respect the user's system appearance and glass setting.
- **Type:** system font. Window title 23 bold, row title 14 semibold, body 13.
- **Colors:** one accent (Clear Blue by default), Safe in green, Ask first in amber. Each section has its own colored icon square.
- **Radii:** window 28, panels and cards 20, rows 14.
- **Accessibility:** visible focus rings, keyboard access for every checkbox and switch, reduced motion respected, contrast checked in light and dark.

6. Email and accounts

- Email is required at first run, for free and paid users. No password and no sign-up form.
- Two kinds of email. **Transactional** (license, receipts, security, restoring your plan): always sent, required. **Marketing** (updates, new products): only if the user ticks the opt-in box, which starts unticked. Unsubscribe anytime in Settings, Notifications.
- Returning users: Sign in or activate with email and license key, or an emailed sign-in link.

- Store: email, opt-in choice and timestamp, plan, license key, hashed Mac ID, Mac name, last-seen date and app version. Nothing else for licensing.
- Have a lawyer review consent wording, the privacy policy and refund terms, especially for the EU.

7. Plans, prices and licensing

Prices for testing: monthly $4.99, $7.99, $12.99; yearly $29.99, $44.99, $74.99; one-time (version 1) $79.99, $119.99, $189.99; for 1, 2 and 5 Macs.

- One-time covers version 1. Support for new macOS versions ends when version 2 ships, and version 2 is a discounted upgrade. Subscribers always get updates.
- Priority support, scheduled scans and the menu bar monitor are for monthly and yearly only.
- Suggested tools: Paddle for payments and Keygen for licensing. Check current terms and fees before choosing.
- Details are in the License and device locking doc.

8. Landing page

- **Sections:** hero with a MacBook showing the app, three promises, chapters (Scan, See it first, Find the big stuff, Builders, Safe by default), Everything in one app, stats, Matches your Mac, testimonials, pricing with tables, FAQ, final call to action.
- **Interactive parts:** the appearance panel (Auto, Light, Dark, a Glass slider and accent colors), the before and after slider, the pricing toggles, the scroll-stacked chapters. Appearance choices are saved in the browser.
- **To wire up:** the Download and Buy buttons, the Privacy, Terms and Support links, a download-link email form for phone visitors.
- **To replace:** every item tagged Placeholder (stats, ratings, testimonials, minimum macOS). Do not ship fake reviews or ratings.
- **Rules for copy:** no file paths anywhere, and no claims we cannot prove, such as 'the best'.
- **Fonts:** system font first, Inter as a fallback.

9. What is simulated in the prototypes

Payments, sign-in links, emails, license checks, Reveal in Finder, Time Machine status, Quick Look content, update downloads, all scan data, the menu bar item, and every size, path and app name.

10. Open questions for you

- Minimum macOS version, and Intel plus Apple silicon builds?
- How are cleanup rules stored and updated safely, without a full release?
- Which license server and payment provider, and what is the activation API?
- How do updates ship (an in-app updater, notarization, hardened runtime)?
- Direct download assumed, because the Mac App Store sandbox blocks most of what a cleaner does. Confirm.
- Analytics and crash reporting: what is collected, and is it covered in the privacy policy?
- Which macOS versions and how many real Macs for testing?

11. Suggested build order

1. Scan engine, cleanup rules as data, the protected list, Trash with Undo, history storage.
2. App shell: sidebar, Overview, Clean, inspector, floating bar, sheets.
3. Free-plan limits and masking, 500 MB allowance, upgrade flow.
4. Email capture, license activation, device list, offline grace.
5. Storage Map, Large files with Quick Look, Apps uninstaller, Builders pack.
6. Settings, Startup Items, Privacy Check, menus and shortcuts.
7. Error states, accessibility, notarization, update flow.
8. Version 1.1: duplicates, menu bar monitor, scheduled scans, maintenance.

If time runs short, cut in this order: Privacy Check, Startup Items, extra Builders items, backup warnings. Keep the safety layer, Smart Scan, Storage Map, large files and the uninstaller.

12. Done means

The full checklist is in the feature specification. Before launch, confirm that no protected item can be selected, that Undo restores exactly, that free limits and masking hold, that a scan finds real space on ordinary test Macs, and that cleaning turns off on an untested macOS.